

Music

Hymns & Spirituals

Folk Songs

Afternoon Listening

Composer Study

Sol-fa





About the Course

This course includes the following topic(s): Composer Study, Hymns & Spirituals, Folk Songs, Sol-fa: Level 5, Afternoon Listening

About Hymns & Spirituals

Students sing hymns and spirituals to build their faith and appreciation of God's work across time. Hymns and spirituals are connected to the historical time period as appropriate.

About Folk Songs

Students sing folk songs connected to the time period (1800-1900).

About Composer Study

In this course students are immersed into the 19th century via its composers, instruments, and musical performances. Term 1 focuses on several influential instruments/instrument families, including valved brass, the veena, and the guitar, and the musicians that made them famous. In Term 2, students will grow to know and love the Norwegian Romantic composer, Edvard Grieg. Students conclude the year in Term 3 with the comic operas of Gilbert & Sullivan and their choice between two composers who turned what they saw or heard into music: Modest Mussorgsky and Thomas ("Blind Tom") Wiggins.

About Sol-fa: Level 5

Learn to sight-sing in new keys, time signatures, and rhythms. Continue studying the basics of music theory. Train ears with melodic and rhythmic ear tests, learn how to compose music, and gain further freedom and facility in sight-singing. Audio lessons are included in the lesson plans.

Skills Focus: Time signatures, note values, scales, and dictation.

Hymns & Spirituals

The Christian hymn and spiritual tradition is incredibly rich, and it is vanishing from many churches. In addition to bringing a much-needed moment of peace to your day, hymns can also introduce students to important theological ideas and church liturgy.

Folk Songs

The purpose of learning folk songs is twofold: to increase students' enjoyment of music and to situate folk music in its historical context in an effort to give students a richer understanding of the times and places that birthed the songs. A musical score is sometimes included for songs, but does not always exactly match the audio used, since folk songs are primarily oral songs and often take many different forms. Studying folk music helps students grow deep roots in our shared heritage and gives insight into historical events from the perspective of the people who were there.

Composer Study

"Music is no isolated thing. Its forms, colors, and expressive qualities do not spring from nowhere; they come out of life itself. Often, of course, they are to be enjoyed for themselves alone, in the concert hall or in one's armchair. But music also reflects human experiences, hopes, and struggles. It may give an insight into the individual and society, into the lives of those far removed from our own in time and place—an insight no other art can provide in this exact way." ~Elie Siegmeister



Placement & Combining Tips

All music lessons except sol-fa are shared between Grades 2-12, making them ideal lessons for multi-age groups.

Composer Study

These Composer Study lessons are shared across grades 2-12 with extensions provided for older students. Students in Grades 2-3 with no classical music background may choose to take Intro to Music Appreciation first, but the composers in this rotation are particularly accessible for a wide range of ages.

Sol-fa: Level 5

Prerequisite: Sight-Singing with Sol-fa Level 4 or appropriate skill proficiency. Students in Grades 4+ with no experience with sol-fa or sight-reading music should start with Level 2.



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
1-12	Hymns & Spirituals 1 time/week 10 min	Our Hymns, Our Heritage
1-12	Folk Songs 1 time/week 10 min	Like a Bird: The Art of the American Slave Song
1-12	Afternoon Listening 1+ time/week 10 min	
2-12	Composer Study 1 time/week 10 min 1 time/week 15 min	Playlist for the Year Mussorgsky's Pictures at an Exhibition Song in a Rainstorm: The Story of Musical Prodigy Thomas Blind Tom Wiggins
6-12	Sol-fa: Level 5 1 time/week 15 min	Fifty Steps in Sight-Singing Sol-fa Level 5 Audio Lessons
	Shared course resources	Our Work: Grades 4-6 Our Work: Grades 7-8 Our Work: Grades 9-12 Hymns, Spirituals, & Folk Songs PDF

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
Music: Level 5				
Sol-fa: Level 5 Afternoon Listening	Hymns & Spirituals	Folk Songs	Composer Study	



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.

Hymns & Spirituals

☐ Bookmark the Alveary hymns, spirituals, and folk song playlist for the year, or create your own YouTube, Spotify, or Amazon playlist if desired.

Composer Study

- Charlotte Mason often included more music in the program than could be covered in the lesson time. While we choose segments that fit the length of the lesson, students will develop a relationship with the term's music insofar as it is a part of their daily atmosphere.
- The YouTube playlist contains nearly the whole year's music, though lessons will occasionally have extra links to historical or musical information. Feel free to create your own playlist if you prefer other platforms to YouTube; though videos are often chosen for visual and sometimes historical interest, the crucial element is the music itself.

- Use the year's playlist to listen to previous and current pieces in the afternoons, and explore the Extra Helpings as interested (ideas which relate directly to a lesson are usually included nearby, while more general resources and activities are listed on the Extra Helpings page). Grade 5+ extensions are also usually appropriate as Extra Helpings for interested younger students.

Sol-fa: Level 5

- ☐ Bookmark Sol-fa playlists (see Quick Links). If you create a free account on the SoundCloud app, the Sol-Fa lessons become downloadable for offline use.

Term Prep & Teacher Tips

Composer Study

- ☐ Lessons on Handel's Messiah are scheduled at the beginning of Term 2, so many students will reach them around the Christmas holidays. However, depending on how you schedule your year, this may not fit. Feel free to complete the lessons whenever suits your schedule. The Messiah is as much (or more) an Easter piece as a Christmas one, so you could even bump it to Term 3!



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

Music: Level 5



Our Work: Grades 4-6



Our Work: Grades 7-8



Our Work: Grades 9-12



Hymns, Spirituals, & Folk Songs PDF

Hymns & Spirituals



Our Hymns, Our Heritage

Folk Songs



Like a Bird: The Art of the American Slave Song

Composer Study



Playlist for the Year



Mussorgsky's Pictures at an Exhibition



Song in a Rainstorm: The Story of Musical Prodigy Thomas Blind Tom Wiggins

Sol-fa: Level 5



Fifty Steps in Sight-Singing



Sol-fa Level 5 Audio Lessons



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

- ∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)
- ∞ [View Supply List Details](#)

Sol-fa: Level 5



Piano or Keyboard



Quick Links

Music: Level 5

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Hymns & Spirituals

- ∞ [Hymns, Spirituals, & Folk Songs PDF](#)

Composer Study

- ∞ [Extra Resource: Classics for Kids Musical Dictionary](#)
- ∞ [Composer Study Playlist](#)
- ∞ [Appendix: Musical Vocabulary](#)

Sol-fa: Level 5

- ∞ [Warm-Ups \(Audio\)](#)
- ∞ [Warm-Ups \(Video\)](#)
- ∞ [Blank Staff Paper](#)
- ∞ [Appendix: Additional Answer Key](#)

Music: Level 5

How To Teach



Recap

- Specific recap questions are often suggested in the day's plans; ask students what they remember from the last lesson. If nothing comes to mind at first, tell them to give themselves another minute or two and to keep thinking. Our brains are amazing and can usually recall the previous lesson with a minute of effort. Refrain from doing the work of remembering yourself if you are leading the lessons.
- For composer study, a recap might look like a brief discussion about the name or sound of the piece you listened to previously.
- For hymns and folk songs, this might be an effort to hum the melody or recite the words of the song you're currently learning.
- For sol-fa, it might be a quick explanation of the sol-fa syllable you learned or a tricky rhythm or interval you were working to master.
- If students have difficulty recalling, teachers might try showing them a picture or sharing something that the teacher remembers. This will often refresh their memory enough to allow them to recall.
- If students still cannot recall anything from the last reading, then teachers may consider continuing anyway or repeating the last lesson.



Introduce

- Prepare to listen to the day's musical selection by inviting students to consider an interesting musical or historical idea in the lesson. Perhaps it's a unique word, rhythm, instrument, or piece of historical background. You might introduce it by the way, or read a selection of a composer's bio or a brief article to students.



Listen & Sing

- Listen to the day's musical selection.
- Composer study lessons will usually have you listen to a piece of music for 3-8 minutes. If students have a difficult time listening for the duration of the lesson, stop the music at their limit.
- Some students might draw, color, or engage in a handicraft while listening to help extend their listening time. Students who have a difficult time sitting still or listening may benefit from: a fidget of their choice, such as a piece of putty or clay or an afghan; flexible positioning, such as a wobble seat or inverted sitting; or sensory modulation, such as a weighted vest or blanket or adjustment of light, temperature, or sound.
- Hymn, folk song, or sol-fa lessons will sometimes have you listen to a part of the song and then practice echoing back the melody and/or words.



Discuss

- Composer Study: Talk about the musical selection you heard. What stood out to you? What did you notice? What did it make you wonder? Did it remind you of anything? Discuss the tempo, the sound of the music, the instruments used, the volume, and the mood. Why do you think the composer wrote it the way he did?
- Hymns, Spirituals, & Folk Songs: What lines strike you particularly? Is there a rhyme scheme to the lyrics? Is there a progression to each stanza? If you were to add a verse to the song, what would you

add? If you took a verse out, how do you think it would change the song? Do the melody and words go together? Why or why not?

- Sol-fa: Take a minute to reflect on what you learned in the lesson. Write down any notes you want to remember and practice any particular exercises that were tricky.



Connect

- At the end of the lesson, think about how the day's musical selection connects to other books, subjects, characters in history, etc.
- You might copy down a stanza of a hymn in your *Commonplace* or *Copywork* book, read a bit more about the history behind a piece of music, jot down a noteworthy date in your *Book of Centuries*, or discuss a broader question raised in the lesson.



Term 1

WEEK 1 15m Sol-fa: Level 5 - Lesson 1

Step 24a

Materials: Fifty Steps in Sight Singing

→ INTRO

We're continuing to learn how to sing in multiple keys this term. But before you sing, warm up your voice.

∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups

∞ Video Link: Warm-Ups

→ LISTEN & PRACTICE

Write down the sol-fa syllables and note names for the exercise at the very top of p.27 to familiarize yourself with the key of F. Then sing with the recording. (See Appendix for note names.)

∞ Audio Link: Step 24a Answer Key

WEEK 1 10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 1

How Firm a Foundation

Materials: Our Hymns, Our Heritage, Our Work Book, and/or Music Selections Booklet

→ INTRO

Our first hymn this year is called "How Firm a Foundation." What is a foundation, and what do you think this hymn will be about?

→ LISTEN & PRACTICE

Today, focus on getting familiar with the hymn. Read the words aloud and listen to the full song. Note that various recordings sometimes use the older "thee" rather than "you" and annotate your lyrics depending on the recording you use. Notice, talk about, and look up any unfamiliar words.

∞ Audio Link: How Firm a Foundation (YouTube or Spotify)

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Learn the history of the song from Our Hymns, Our Heritage. "Text and Tune" p.136

• EXTRA HELPINGS

Look at early copies of Rippon's hymnal. What differences and similarities do you notice between it and hymnals today? If interested, read the original hymn (note the extra verses which are less common today) and the prefaces.

∞ Book Links: 1801 and 1828 versions

• AFTERNOON LISTENING

Use your preferred recording to listen to the hymn in the afternoons, evenings, or anytime! The more you spend time with it, the more the words will sink into your head and your heart.

• IMPORTANT DATE

"How Firm a Foundation" published in Rippon's hymnal (1787 AD).

WEEK 1 10m Folk Songs - Lesson 1

Yankee Doodle

Materials: Our Work or Music PDF

PREP: Lyrics are included in your Our Work booklet or Music PDF. Print off the tune if you like as well.

∞ PDF Link: Yankee Doodle Sheet Music

→ INTRO

What does the word "Yankee" mean? Our first folk song of the year is one of the most famous American folk songs, but it actually started as a British insult! Learn more about the history and then listen to the song today.

★ TEACHER NOTE

Feel free to choose your own version of Yankee Doodle to learn. Just know that the lyrics vary widely, so another audio or video is unlikely to match the words in your Our Work or Music books.

• AFTERNOON LISTENING

Be sure to listen to the term's songs throughout the week!



Term 1

∞ Article Link: Yankee Doodle History

→ LISTEN & DISCUSS

∞ Video Link: Yankee Doodle

• IMPORTANT DATE

Yankee Doodle was first composed (~1755 AD)

WEEK 1 15m Composer Study - Lesson 1

WEEK 2 15m Sol-fa: Level 5 - Lesson 2

Step 24b

Materials: Fifty Steps in Sight Singing

→ RECAP

Review concepts from the last lesson.

→ WARM UP

Prepare your voice for singing.

∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups

∞ Video Link: Warm-Ups

→ LISTEN & PRACTICE

Write, sing, or clap back melodies or rhythms as directed. See Appendix for complete answer key to today's melodic dictation.

∞ Audio Link: Step 24b

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WEEK 2 10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 2

How Firm a Foundation (cont.)

Materials: Our Hymns, Our Heritage and/or Music PDF or Our Work Book, Bible

→ RECAP

What is the name of the hymn for this term, and what is it about? Tell anything else you remember about its history.

→ SING

Practice the tune by first listening to a verse, then humming the next two.

∞ Video Link: How Firm a Foundation Full Song

→ READ & DISCUSS

Let's focus on the lyrics a bit more. Read the whole song aloud, then look up the Bible verses below (mentioned last week in your hymnal) and tell what you notice about the images, ideas, or even direct words that the hymn writer used from each verse.

- Isaiah 41:10 (Stanza 2)

- Isaiah 43:2 (Stanza 3 & 4)

- Zechariah 13:9 (Stanza 4)

- John 10:27-29, Romans 8:38-39, Hebrews 13:5-6 (Stanza 5)

→ (OPTIONAL) COPYWORK (GRADES 4+)

Write one of the Bible verses above underneath your hymn lyrics or in your copywork book.

★ TEACHER TIP

If teaching in a classroom setting, assign verses to various students to keep this part of the lesson from taking too long.

• EXTRA HELPING

More on the song's history and how the author used bible verses in his composition. Note the additional verse

∞ Video Link: Hymn Story, Analysis, Performance



Term 1

WEEK 2 10m Folk Songs - Lesson 2

Yankee Doodle (cont.)

Materials: Our Work or Music PDF, United States Atlas or a Globe

→ RECAP

What do you remember about the history of "Yankee Doodle"?

→ SING

Listen to the full song, paying attention to the lyrics. Then listen again and hum along. You might want to march as well! Spend some time reading and memorizing the lyrics (use your Our Work or Music booklet).

∞ Video Link: Yankee Doodle

→ EXPLORE

With the remaining time or in the afternoon, explore pieces that have Yankee Doodle incorporated into them! Just as books make references to earlier works, composers often make musical references to other songs. The more you know about music, the more musical references you will catch! It's like picking up on an inside joke in a conversation!

∞ Article & Video: 200 Years of Yankee Doodle

WEEK 2 15m Composer Study - Lesson 2

WEEK 3 15m Sol-fa: Level 5 - Lesson 3

Step 24c

Materials: Fifty Steps in Sight Singing

→ RECAP

Review concepts from the last lesson.

→ WARM UP

Prepare your voice for singing.

∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups

∞ Video Link: Warm-Ups

→ LISTEN & PRACTICE

Write, sing, or clap back melodies or rhythms as directed. See Appendix for complete answer key to today's melodic dictation.

∞ Audio Link: Step 24c

∞ Audio Link: Step 24c Answer Key

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WEEK 3 10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 3

How Firm a Foundation (cont.)

Materials: Our Hymns, Our Heritage and/or Music PDF or Our Work Book

→ RECAP

Sing the tune of How Firm a Foundation on "hoo" and read the words aloud. Pay attention to the meaning and punctuation as you read.

→ SING & DISCUSS

Today, listen to a line of the song, then pause the video and echo it back, working your way line by line through the song. This will help you focus on each line of the song, not just the ones which come easily to you.

∞ Video Link: How Firm a Foundation Full Song



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- What images or lines in the song do you like best?

→ COPYWORK (GRADE 4+)

Copy a line of the melody into your music journal and (if you are taking sol-fa), see if you can label the notes with the sol-fa syllables. Hint: it is written in the key of G, and the first note is "So." Count up how many different sol-fa syllables you used in the song [there should be five]. This hymn is written using the pentatonic scale (often a major scale omitting fa and ti). Many other hymns (like Amazing Grace) are also written with only these five different sol-fa syllables. Explore Extra Helpings to explore a music theory rabbit hole on pentatonic music.

WEEK 3 10m Folk Songs - Lesson 3

Yankee Doodle (cont.)

Materials: Our Work or Music PDF

→ RECAP

Can you hum the tune of "Yankee Doodle"?

→ SING & PRACTICE

Write down the first line of each verse to help yourself remember the order. Then sing along with the recording. If you need to focus more closely on the words, pause the video after a line and echo it back yourself.

∞ Video Link: Yankee Doodle

→ WRITE (OPTIONAL)

Like most folk songs (and even hymns), many different verses have come and gone from Yankee Doodle. If you want a challenge, try composing some of your own additional or alternate verses! Try singing your lyrics with the tune to make sure you have the right rhythm (you'll notice that there are four beats in each line).

• MUSIC CONNECTION

If you play an instrument, try playing the melody of Yankee Doodle!

WEEK 3 15m Composer Study - Lesson 3

WEEK 4 15m Sol-fa: Level 5 - Lesson 4

Step 24d

Materials: Fifty Steps in Sight Singing

→ RECAP

Review concepts from the last lesson.

→ WARM UP

Prepare your voice for singing.

∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups

∞ Video Link: Warm-Ups

→ LISTEN & PRACTICE

Write, sing, or clap back melodies or rhythms as directed. See Appendix for complete answer key to today's melodic dictation.

∞ Audio Link: Step 24d

∞ Audio Link: Step 24d Answer Key

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Term 1

WEEK 4 10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 4

How Firm a Foundation (cont.)

Materials: Our Hymns, Our Heritage and/or Music PDF or Our Work Book

✕ GATHER SUPPLIES: Paints or sketching materials

→ RECAP

Recite the hymn (as much as able).

→ SING

Try to sing the whole song with the accompaniment. Note the areas where you aren't as sure of the tune or the words.

∞ Video Link: How Firm a Foundation Tune

→ ILLUSTRATE

With remaining time (and feel free to continue on your own time if desired), sketch or paint an illustration for each verse in your music notebook or alongside your lyrics.

★ TEACHER TIP

If a student has a hard time coming up with an idea for an illustration, encourage them to focus on just one image from a verse to illustrate. There are no wrong illustrations as long as the student connects it to an aspect of the verse in their mind. The purpose is simply to help them inhabit and reflect on the verse in a different way.

WEEK 4 10m Folk Songs - Lesson 4

Yankee Doodle (cont.)

Materials: Our Work or Music PDF

→ RECAP

Sing as much of "Yankee Doodle" as you can from memory. Note the spots where you get stuck!

→ SING & PRACTICE

Read the lyrics and work on any spots you got stuck. Then try singing the song with the instrumental (use your lyrics, not the video's). When it ends, keep singing the rest of the verses a cappella. Make up your own accompaniment by clapping or marching if you like!

∞ Video Link: Yankee Doodle Tune

→ DISCUSS

Can you imagine being a soldier and first hearing this tune as an insult? Can you think of any other examples of something that started as a put-down but was then reclaimed to mean something else?

• EXTRA HELPINGS (Grade 10+)

Read Percival Everett's short story "The Appropriation of Cultures" (linked in Extra Helpings) to think more about how songs or other cultural symbols gain and change connotations.

WEEK 4 15m Composer Study - Lesson 4

WEEK 5 15m Sol-fa: Level 5 - Lesson 5

Step 24e

Materials: Fifty Steps in Sight Singing

→ RECAP

Review concepts from the last lesson.

→ WARM UP

Prepare your voice for singing.

∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups

∞ Video Link: Warm-Ups

→ LISTEN & PRACTICE

Write, sing, or clap back melodies or rhythms as directed. See Appendix for the complete answer key to today's melodic dictation.



Term 1

∞ Audio Link: Step 24e
 ∞ Audio Link: Step 24e Answer Key
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WEEK 5 10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 5

How Firm a Foundation (cont.)

📄 Materials: Our Hymns, Our Heritage and/or Music PDF or Our Work Book

→ RECAP

Sing hymn from memory (as able).

→ SING

Now that you know the words better, experiment with how you sing the song. Pick a few ideas to try or come up with your own. Think about how to emphasize the meaning of the words by the way you sing different verses. Are there other instruments you would use? Use the recording as needed.

- Sing some verses faster or slower.
- Sing some parts soft and some loud.
- Sing the song as a 2-part canon. To do this, divide into two groups (if with at least two people) or use the recording as your second person if solo. Group 1 should start singing, and then Group 2 begins at the beginning when Group 1 hits the "tion" in "foundation" in the first line (see #57 in Our Hymns, Our Heritage to see where Group 2 comes in). Because of the way the song is composed, the two groups will sound nice together even while singing different words!

∞ Audio Link: How Firm a Foundation Tune

• EXTRA HELPINGS

Experiment with more than two groups singing this hymn in a canon or round, and try starting at different places to see what sounds best. For instance, Group 2 could wait to start until Group 1 begins the second line of music in your hymnal. Or you could try having four different groups!

WEEK 5 10m Folk Songs - Lesson 5

Yankee Doodle (cont.)

📄 Materials: Our Work or Music PDF

→ RECAP

Sing as much of Yankee Doodle as you can from memory.

→ SING & PRACTICE

Work on any spots you struggled with in the recap. Then, using the instrumental track or just your voice, sing all of Yankee Doodle (use lyrics if needed). Experiment with how you sing each verse. Try singing one loud and proud, another like you're telling a secret to a friend, etc. If you wrote any of your own verses, add them in as well!

∞ Video Link: Yankee Doodle Tune

→ WRITE (OPTIONAL)

Refine or add more of your own verses to the song!

WEEK 5 15m Composer Study - Lesson 5

WEEK 6 15m Sol-fa: Level 5 - Lesson 6

Review: Step 17a

📄 Materials: Fifty Steps in Sight Singing

→ RECAP

Review concepts from the last lesson.

→ WARM UP



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Prepare your voice for singing.

∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups

∞ Video Link: Warm-Ups

→ LISTEN & PRACTICE

Over the next few weeks, you'll revisit Steps 17 & 19 since they introduced foundational topics that you want to know well before moving forward.

∞ Audio Link: Step 17a

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WEEK 6

10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 6

Children of the Heavenly Father

📄 Materials: Our Hymns, Our Heritage

(Optional) PREP: Read p.170 in your hymnal and the longer article about Lina and mark additional sections to share.

∞ Article Link: More about Lina

→ RECAP

Warm up your voice by singing "How Firm a Foundation."

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

You might not have heard of our second hymn this term, but it is a beautiful reminder of God's love for his children. Read from the hymnal and share any additional sections from the article as desired (older students can read the article directly).

Our Hymns, Our Heritage, "Text and Tune" p.170

→ LISTEN, PRACTICE, & DISCUSS

Bookmark #74 in Our Hymns, Our Heritage, and read the English words aloud. Then listen to the full song.

∞ Video Link: Children of the Heavenly Father YouTube

∞ Audio Link: Children of the Heavenly Father Spotify

- What did you think of the song after hearing a bit about Lina's life?
- Discuss any unfamiliar words.

• IMPORTANT DATE

Carolina Sandell Berg
(Sweden, 1823-1903 AD)

• EXTRA HELPINGS

Listen to the song in the original Swedish (and feel free to learn the song in Swedish instead of English if you'd rather!).

∞ YouTube Links: Tryggare kan ingen vara

WEEK 6

10m Folk Songs - Lesson 6

Sakura, Sakura

📄 Materials: Our Work or Music PDF, Globe or World Atlas

→ RECAP

Hum or sing the first few verses of Yankee Doodle.

→ INTRO

Today we're starting a new folk song about cherry blossoms! The tune originated sometime during the Edo Period (1603-1868) in Japan, which was a time of relative stability and peace. Over the years, it has become internationally famous and has been performed around the world.

→ VIEW & MAPWORK

Cherry blossoms have been important to Japanese culture for centuries, and festivals to view them in peak season take place every spring. Learn a bit more about this tradition and look at the pictures of some of the beautiful places in Japan. You may want to pull out Google Maps or an atlas and locate the different places mentioned as well!

∞ Article Link: Sakura in Japan



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→ LISTEN

Listen to the song once or twice and follow along with the lyrics. Print off the sheet music tune if desired.

∞ Video Link: Sakura, Sakura

∞ Image Link: Sakura Sheet Music

WEEK 6 15m Composer Study - Lesson 6

WEEK 7 15m Sol-fa: Level 5 - Lesson 7

Review: Step 17b

 Materials: Fifty Steps in Sight Singing

→ RECAP

Review concepts from the last lesson.

→ WARM UP

Prepare your voice for singing.

∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups

∞ Video Link: Warm-Ups

→ LISTEN & PRACTICE

Revisit Step 17 to refresh your memory and see how you've grown!

∞ Audio Link: Step 17b

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WEEK 7 10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 7

Children of the Heavenly Father (cont.)

 Materials: Our Hymns, Our Heritage and/or Our Work or Music PDF, Globe or World Atlas

→ RECAP & MAPWORK

- What is "Children of the Heavenly Father" about?
- Locate Sweden on your atlas or globe. Can you find Småland or Stockholm?

→ READ & SING

- Read the lyrics aloud.
- Write down the beginning of each verse to help you remember the order.
- Work on the tune by alternating between listening and humming with the verses. Slow down and pause the tune after each line and hum the melody back if you run into any tricky spots.
- ∞ Music Links: Children of the Heavenly Father (YouTube or Spotify)

→ DISCUSS

Can you think of any Bible stories or verses that Lina might have thought of when she wrote this song? [One option to read and discuss: Isaiah 40:11 and see the Extra Helping link for additional reflections on each verse]

• EXTRA HELPINGS

- ∞ Article Link: Reflections on CofthF

WEEK 7 10m Folk Songs - Lesson 7

Sakura, Sakura (cont.)

 Materials: Our Work or Music PDF

→ RECAP

Can you hum the beginning of the tune of Sakura, Sakura?

→ SING & PRACTICE

Listen to the song and pay attention to how each word is pronounced. Then listen



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again and pause the video after each line to echo it back.

∞ Video Link: Sakura, Sakura

→ VIEW

The song is often performed on the koto, a Japanese stringed instrument which became very popular in the 1700s. Listen to this instrumental version of our song with extra time.

∞ Video Link: Sakura Sakura (Koto)

WEEK 7 15m Composer Study - Lesson 7

WEEK 8 15m Sol-fa: Level 5 - Lesson 8

Review: Step 19a

Materials: Fifty Steps in Sight Singing

→ RECAP

Review concepts from the last lesson.

→ WARM UP

Prepare your voice for singing.

∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups

∞ Video Link: Warm-Ups

→ LISTEN & PRACTICE

Try to sing the exercises even more smoothly this time around.

∞ Audio Link: Step 19a

∞ Audio Link: Step 19a Answer Key

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WEEK 8 10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 8

Children of the Heavenly Father (cont.)

Materials: Our Hymns, Our Heritage and/or Our Work or Music PDF

→ RECAP

Can you recite or sing the first verse without looking at the lyrics?

→ SING

Practice singing "Children of the Heavenly Father" today. If you can hum the whole tune from memory, sing the words along with the recording. If you are still working on the melody, pause the video after each line and sing it back. This will help you learn the song in its entirety.

∞ Music Links: Children of the Heavenly Father (YouTube or Spotify)

→ WRITE OR ILLUSTRATE

• Describe or start to sketch an illustration for each verse of the song, OR (Grades 6+) pick a verse from the song and rewrite it in your own words.

• COMPOSITION (Grades 7+)

Paraphrase the rest of the song in prose (or feel free to write a poetic paraphrase!).

WEEK 8 10m Folk Songs - Lesson 8

Sakura, Sakura (cont.)

Materials: Our Work or Music PDF

→ RECAP

Recite as many of the words (or sing as much of the song) as you can from memory.

→ INTRO

Did you know that Japan gifted thousands of cherry trees to the US in the early



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1900s? To this day, people flock to Washington, DC, to see the cherry blossoms in the spring!

∞ Article Link: Cherry Blossoms in the US

→ SING

Continue working on the words and tune! Focus on the words by pausing the video after a line to echo the song back.

∞ Video Link: Sakura, Sakura

WEEK 8 15m Composer Study - Lesson 8

WEEK 9 15m Sol-fa: Level 5 - Lesson 9

Review Step 19b

 Materials: Fifty Steps in Sight Singing

→ RECAP

Review concepts from the last lesson.

→ WARM UP

Prepare your voice for singing.

∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups

∞ Video Link: Warm-Ups

→ LISTEN & PRACTICE

Try to sing the exercises even more smoothly this time around.

∞ Audio Link: Step 19b

∞ Audio Link: Step 19b Answer Key

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WEEK 9 10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 9

Children of the Heavenly Father (cont.)

 Materials: Our Hymns, Our Heritage and/or Our Work or Music PDF, Globe or US Atlas

→ RECAP

Recite "Children of the Heavenly Father" (as able), and mark any spots that need work.

→ SING

Warm up your voice by humming a favorite song, then sing "Children of the Heavenly Father" with the accompaniment (without looking at the words if you can!). Don't worry if you make a mistake; just keep going and then go back afterward to check the words and sing the song again.

∞ Video Link: Children of the Heavenly Father Tune

→ READ & DISCUSS

Tell what you know about events happening around the world in the 1800s from anything you've learned in other subjects.

One of the reasons this hymn became so popular not only in Swedish but in English was due to two things: the famous soprano Jenny Lind who toured in North America and sang some of Lina's songs and the number of Swedes who immigrated to North America. We'll learn more about Jenny Lind next lesson.

∞ Article Link: Swedish Immigration



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WEEK 9 10m Folk Songs - Lesson 9

Sakura, Sakura (cont.)

Materials: Our Work or Music PDF

→ RECAP

Sing "Yankee Doodle" from earlier in the term. Can you remember it?

→ LISTEN & SING

Listen to the full song once, following along with the words. Then try to sing the song yourself a cappella (with just your voice).

∞ Video Link: Sakura, Sakura

→ STUDY

If you take sol-fa or an instrument, look at the sheet music of this folk song and count how many different tones are used. The same note in a different octave doesn't add to the count (for instance, just count one B). How many different tones did you find? [Answer: 5] Much of Japanese music is composed with a scale of five notes, and this song uses the hirajoshi scale (see examples in the link below). This scale is a default scale for the koto instrument as standardized by a famous Koto player in the 17th century, Yatsuhashi Kengyō. Play around with these five notes and see what other tunes you can come up with, or try playing Sakura starting on a different note than shown in the sheet music, but using the same scale.

∞ Image Link: Sakura Sheet Music

∞ Article Link: Hirajoshi Scale

• EXTRA HELPINGS

Using the hirajoshi scale, compose an "introduction" or ending melody to Sakura, Sakura.

WEEK 9 15m Composer Study - Lesson 9

WEEK 10 15m Sol-fa: Level 5 - Lesson 10

Review Step 19c

Materials: Fifty Steps in Sight Singing

→ RECAP

Review concepts from the last lesson.

→ WARM UP

Prepare your voice for singing.

∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups

∞ Video Link: Warm-Ups

→ LISTEN & PRACTICE

Try to sing the exercises even more smoothly this time around.

∞ Audio Link: Step 19c

∞ Audio Link: Step 19c Answer Key

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WEEK 10 10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 10

Children of the Heavenly Father (cont.)

Materials: Our Hymns, Our Heritage and/or Our Work or Music PDF

→ RECAP

Can you still sing "How Firm a Foundation" from the first part of the term?

→ SING & DISCUSS

• Sing the song without the accompaniment. Then check yourself with the tune and lyrics.

• EXTRA HELPINGS

Listen to a beautiful choir arrangement of Children of the Heavenly Father!

∞ Audio Link: Dan Forrest Arrangement



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- Sing the song again and experiment. Although many recordings play the melody quite slowly, aspects of the tune feel more like a lullaby or dance. Try singing it like a lullaby, and play with the dynamics (speed, volume, etc.). What type of singing best fits each verse?

∞ Video Link: Children of the Heavenly Father Tune

→ (OPTIONAL) LISTEN & DISCUSS

Jenny Lind was a sensational singer and devout Christian from Sweden (and recently fictionalized in *The Greatest Showman*). She popularized Carolina Berg's melodies in her concerts. With the remaining time, learn more about Jenny's tour via video or article.

∞ Article Link: About Jenny Lind (Article)

∞ Video Link: About Jenny Lind (Video)

WEEK 10 10m Folk Songs - Lesson 10

Sakura, Sakura (cont.)

📄 Materials: Our Work or Music PDF

→ RECAP

What would you say is the "mood" or feeling of Sakura based on what you know about the words?

→ SING

Can you sing the song from memory now? Listen to the song first before trying, if needed.

∞ Video Link: Sakura, Sakura

WEEK 10 15m Composer Study - Lesson 10

WEEK 11 15m Sol-fa: Level 5 - Lesson 11

Mystery Tune

→ RECAP

Review concepts from the last lesson.

→ WARM UP

Prepare your voice for singing.

∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups

∞ Video Link: Warm-Ups

→ PRACTICE

Write out the sol-fa syllables and the names of the top notes of this melody in the key of F. (Hint: The song starts on the So below Do.) Then try to sing it yourself. Do you recognize the tune? Check your work at the very end with the Appendix and by playing the tune via the link given.

∞ Audio Link: Mystery Tune Sheet Music & Audio

WEEK 11 10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 11

Term Recap

📄 Materials: Our Hymns, Our Heritage and/or Our Work or Music PDF

→ RECAP

Try to recite both hymns from the term.

→ SING

Sing both of the term's hymns as if you were a soloist (you may choose to sing with or



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without the accompaniment).

∞ Video Link: How Firm a Foundation Tune

∞ Video Link: Children of the Heavenly Father Tune

WEEK 11 10m Folk Songs - Lesson 11

Term Recap

📄 Materials: Our Work or Music PDF

→ DISCUSS

Which folk song from the term was your favorite? Why?

→ SING

Sing both songs from the term. Use the instrumental with the first part of Yankee Doodle if desired.

∞ Video Link: Yankee Doodle Tune

WEEK 11 15m Composer Study - Lesson 11

WEEK 12 15m Sol-fa: Level 5 - Lesson 12

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to course.

Questions will come from:

Sol-fa Level 5 Coursework

WEEK 12 10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 12

Exam Week

→ ANSWER QUESTION(S) RELATED TO COURSE.

Questions will come from:

Hymns & Spirituals

WEEK 12 10m Folk Songs - Lesson 12

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to the course.

Questions will come from:

Folk Songs

WEEK 12 15m Composer Study - Lesson 12



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WEEK 1 15m Sol-fa: Level 5 - Lesson 13

Review: Step 18

Materials: Fifty Steps in Sight Singing

→ RECAP

Review concepts from the last lesson.

→ WARM UP

Prepare your voice for singing.

∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups

∞ Video Link: Warm-Ups

→ LISTEN & PRACTICE

Sing through all the exercises in Step 18 and check yourself with the answer keys.

∞ Audio Link: Step 18a Answer Key

∞ Audio Link: Step 18b Answer Key

∞ Audio Link: Step 18c Answer Key

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WEEK 1 10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 13

Angels We Have Heard On High

Materials: Our Hymns, Our Heritage and/or Our Work or Music PDF, Bible

→ INTRO

What do you know about the scene where the angels came to the shepherds to tell them about Jesus? If you haven't read it before, look up Luke 2:6-20. Our first song this term depicts this meeting!

→ READ, DISCUSS, & LISTEN

Read the lyrics aloud and discuss any unfamiliar words; then listen to the whole song.

∞ Music Links: Angels We Have Heard (YouTube OR Spotify)

→ READ & NARRATE

Learn the history of the song from your hymnal.

"Text and Tune" p.30

• IMPORTANT DATE

Angels We Have Heard on High published (1855 AD in French; 1862 AD in English)

• EXTRA HELPINGS

The history of this hymn is more complex than the hymnal's condensed version. With various translations and up to twelve original stanzas, the carol's many evolutions show how popular it became in both French and English!

∞ Article Link: History of Translation

∞ Article Link: French Lyrics (includes a more direct English translation).

WEEK 1 10m Folk Songs - Lesson 13

Amazing Grace

Materials: Our Work or Music PDF, and Our Hymns Our Heritage (optional)

PREP: Choose which version of Amazing Grace you want to learn. V1 skips verse 3 in your Music PDF, and V2 omits verse 5 and flips verses 3 and 4, so that the song ends with "The Lord has promised good." Annotate your page according to what you choose.

∞ Video Link: Amazing Grace V1

∞ Video Link: Amazing Grace V2

→ INTRO

Folk songs and hymns are sometimes overlapping categories of music because some hymns become part of the wider culture to the point that they are also folk songs. Amazing Grace is one of those hymns - you probably already know at least some of the song! Read more about the history of this hymn from Our Hymns, Our Heritage,

• IMPORTANT DATE

Amazing Grace was composed in (1772 AD)



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p.238, and/or the link below.

∞ Article Link: The Creation of Amazing Grace

→ LISTEN & DISCUSS

The first verse of Amazing Grace is the most famous, and the other verses are sung in various orders. Read the words aloud for the verses you're learning, then listen to the recording (V1 or V2).

WEEK 1 15m Composer Study - Lesson 13

WEEK 2 15m Sol-fa: Level 5 - Lesson 14

Review: Step 20

📄 Materials: Fifty Steps in Sight Singing

→ RECAP

Review concepts from the last lesson.

→ WARM UP

Prepare your voice for singing.

∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups

∞ Video Link: Warm-Ups

→ LISTEN & PRACTICE

Sing through all the exercises in Step 20 and check yourself with the answer keys.

∞ Audio Link: Step 20a Answer Key

∞ Audio Link: Step 20b Answer Key

∞ Audio Link: Step 20c Answer Key

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WEEK 2 10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 14

Angels We Have Heard On High (cont.)

📄 Materials: Our Hymns, Our Heritage and/or Our Work or Music PDF

→ RECAP

What is "Angels We Have Heard On High" about?

→ STUDY & SING

Today, we're focusing on learning the tune and words separately.

- Even if you can't read music, look at the music in your hymnal and notice that the shape of the top notes in the first line is the same as the second line. So once you learn the tune of the first line of music, you've learned the tune for the rest of the verse!

- Now find the first "Deo" you see in the sheet music. Even though it looks like a lot of notes, you'll see in your Our Work book or Music PDF and notice in the music that for the chorus you sing "Gloria in excelsis Deo" twice. And the only note that is different the second time is the very last note of the song.

- Now listen to the song and pay attention to those repeated lines (feel free to highlight them with different colors or make a note in your lyrics if desired)! Hum along with the recording as you pick up the tune.

∞ Video Link: Angels We Have Heard (YouTube or Spotify)

→ READ & DISCUSS

Read the words of the song aloud either in your hymnal, Our Work, or Music pdf.

• MUSICAL NOTE

When you sing "Gloria" in the chorus, you are singing a melisma – many notes on one syllable. While this is common for songs featuring just one artist, it is uncommon for congregational songs. Can you think of any other melismas in songs you've sung? Melismas are sometimes called "runs" or "riffs" in pop music.



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WEEK 2 10m Folk Songs - Lesson 14

Amazing Grace (cont.)

Materials: Our Work or Music PDF, Globe or world atlas

→ RECAP

What do you remember about the story of John Newton and Amazing Grace?

→ SING

Listen and hum through Amazing Grace (listen to a verse, then hum or "hoo" along with the next one) to learn the tune. Then practice reciting the words.

∞ Video Link: Amazing Grace V1

∞ Video Link: Amazing Grace V2

→ DRAW

Sketch or paint a short illustration to go with each verse.

WEEK 2 15m Composer Study - Lesson 14

WEEK 3 15m Sol-fa: Level 5 - Lesson 15

Step 26a

Materials: Fifty Steps in Sight Singing

→ RECAP

Review concepts from the last lesson.

→ WARM UP

Prepare your voice for singing.

∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups

∞ Video Link: Warm-Ups

→ LISTEN & PRACTICE

Write, sing, or clap back melodies or rhythms as directed.

∞ Audio Link: Step 26a

∞ Audio Link: Step 26a Answer Key

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WEEK 3 10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 15

Angels We Have Heard On High (cont.)

Materials: Our Hymns, Our Heritage and/or Our Work or Music PDF

→ RECAP

Can you sing the chorus of "Angels We Have Heard on High"?

→ SING

We're putting the tune and text together today, so listen to a line of the hymn, then pause and sing it back. If you feel confident in the words, you can sing along; echoing helps us pay attention to each line.

∞ Video Link: Angels We Have Heard (YouTube or Spotify)

→ DISCUSS

Look back at the story in Luke 2 about the angels coming to the shepherds. If you wrote your own poetic/musical retelling of the story, what aspects of the story would you write about in your verses?

• COMPOSITION (Grades 7+)

Write your own retelling of the angels' and shepherds' meeting. You can write it as a poem or carol like "Angels We Have Heard on High," a play, a picture book, or a short story.

Extra challenge: Use a commentary or other study helps from Bible lessons to read more about shepherds in NT times and other aspects of Luke's narrative. Work to incorporate these details into your composition as you imagine what that meeting between angels and



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WEEK 3 10m Folk Songs - Lesson 15

Amazing Grace (cont.)

Materials: Our Work or Music PDF

→ RECAP

Can you sing the first verse from memory?

→ SING & PRACTICE

Write down the first line of each verse you're learning to help you remember the flow of the song. Then sing along with the recording. For lines/verses you don't know well yet, pause the video after the line and sing it back to help you focus on learning that line well.

∞ Video Link: Amazing Grace V1

∞ Video Link: Amazing Grace V2

→ LISTEN

As with all folk songs, the singer and musicians have a lot of freedom to put their own spin on the song. What do you think of this version? Notice which verses she sings or omits.

∞ Video Link: Amazing Grace (Usha Uthup)

shepherds was like for those who were there.

WEEK 3 15m Composer Study - Lesson 15

WEEK 4 15m Sol-fa: Level 5 - Lesson 16

Step 26b

Materials: Fifty Steps in Sight Singing

→ RECAP

Review concepts from the last lesson.

→ WARM UP

Prepare your voice for singing.

∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups

∞ Video Link: Warm-Ups

→ LISTEN & PRACTICE

Write, sing, or clap back melodies or rhythms as directed.

∞ Audio Link: Step 26b

∞ Audio Link: Step 26b Answer Key

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WEEK 4 10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 16

Angels We Have Heard On High (cont.)

Materials: Our Hymns, Our Heritage and/or Our Work or Music PDF

→ RECAP

Recite "Angels We Have Heard On High" from memory (as able).

→ SING

Sing the song with the accompaniment. Note: the accompaniment plays four verses, so you can stop after verse 3 (we're learning the most famous three verses, but as with many carols, others were penned by various translators and authors over the years).

• MUSICAL NOTE

"Angels We Have Heard on High" is a macaronic song, meaning that it uses two different languages (English and Latin) in the same song. Can you think of any other macaronic songs (older or newer)?



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∞ Video Link: Angels We Have Heard Tune

→ LISTEN & DISCUSS

Pick a recording below to hear another way an artist has made this carol their own and attempted to convey its message.

∞ Audio Link: Celtic Women

∞ Audio Link: Aretha Franklin

WEEK 4 □ 10m Folk Songs - Lesson 16

Amazing Grace (cont.)

📄 Materials: Our Work or Music PDF

→ RECAP

Sing as much of Amazing Grace as you can from memory.

→ SING

Check your work with your Our Work booklet or Music PDF and then try to sing with the accompaniment (don't refer to the lyrics on the video because -you guessed it- the lyrics are in a different order again!). Feel free to learn the extra verse to the song in your Our Work/Music book if you're feeling confident about the others!

∞ Video Link: Amazing Grace Tune

→ LISTEN

Here is a country version of Amazing Grace. What do you like (or not) about this style?

∞ Video Link: Amazing Grace (Alan Jackson)

WEEK 4 □ 15m Composer Study - Lesson 16

WEEK 5 □ 15m Sol-fa: Level 5 - Lesson 17

Step 26c

📄 Materials: Fifty Steps in Sight Singing

→ RECAP

Review concepts from the last lesson.

→ WARM UP

Prepare your voice for singing.

∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups

∞ Video Link: Warm-Ups

→ LISTEN & PRACTICE

Write, sing, or clap back melodies or rhythms as directed.

∞ Audio Link: Step 26c

∞ Audio Link: Step 26c Answer Key

p.28

WEEK 5 □ 10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 17

Angels We Have Heard On High (cont.)

📄 Materials: Our Hymns, Our Heritage and/or Our Work or Music PDF

→ RECAP

Try singing "Angels We Have Heard On High" from memory.

→ SING

Review any places or spots you forgot while trying to sing from memory. Sing the



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song again with or without the accompaniment and experiment with how you sing it. For instance, perhaps you sing the last verse very loudly since it's as if the shepherds are calling for everyone to come to worship Jesus! Add some notes for yourself in your music journal or lyric PDF on how you want to sing each verse (how loud, fast, what emotions you want to convey, etc.).

∞ Video Link: Angels We Have Heard Tune

→ LISTEN & DISCUSS

"Angels from the Realms of Glory" is another carol that reflects on similar themes. Some even think it is an alternate translation of the same original French song that produced "Angels We Have Heard on High."

∞ Video Link: Angels from the Realms of Glory

WEEK 5 10m Folk Songs - Lesson 17

Amazing Grace (cont.)

Materials: Our Work or Music PDF

PREP: Print off just the Amazing Grace page from your Our Work/Music Selection PDF and cut the paper so that each verse is on its own strip of paper.

→ RECAP

Can you recite the first line of each verse of "Amazing Grace" that you're learning?

→ SING

Read the words aloud and focus on any that you're still a little unsure of. Then sing along with the instrumental (use lyrics if needed or sing from memory).

∞ Video Link: Amazing Grace Tune

→ REFLECT

You've heard people sing Amazing Grace in a variety of ways and put the verses in different arrangements. Look at the verses in your Our Work/Music Selection book (or use the pre-cut paper) and put the song together a few different ways (you can switch the order of verses or the number). Which way do you like best and why?

• EXTRA HELPINGS

Look at Newton's original six verses and the famous last verse that was added later, and skim the list of recordings that have been made of the song!
∞ Article Link: Original Lyrics

• AFTERNOON LISTENING

Listen to Aretha Franklin's Grammy-winning performance of Amazing Grace and Il Divo's very different performance in the afternoons this week.
∞ Video Link: Amazing Grace (Franklin)
∞ Video Link: Amazing Grace (Il Divo)

WEEK 5 15m Composer Study - Lesson 17

WEEK 6 15m Sol-fa: Level 5 - Lesson 18

Review: Step 21

→ RECAP

Review concepts from the last lesson.

→ WARM UP

Prepare your voice for singing.

∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups

∞ Video Link: Warm-Ups

→ LISTEN & PRACTICE

Review the exercises from Step 21. Can you do them easily now?

∞ Audio Link: Step 21a

∞ Audio Link: Step 21b - Melodic Dictation

∞ Audio Link: Amazing Grace Sheet Music



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WEEK 6 10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 18

O Worship the King

Materials: Our Hymns, Our Heritage and/or Our Work or Music PDF

→ RECAP

Sing "Angels We Have Heard on High" from memory (if you want to challenge yourself, try singing the verses in reverse order!).

→ READ & LISTEN

We're starting a new song!

- Read the lyrics in your Our Work/Music Booklet or #79 in your hymnal.
- Discuss any unfamiliar words.
- Listen to the hymn (note that V2 has an additional chorus you would want to add to your lyrics).
- ∞ Music Links: O Worship the King (YouTube V1, V2, or Spotify)

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Learn the history of the song from your hymnal and/or this short video as time allows.

"Text & Tune" p.182

∞ Video Link: History of O Worship the King

• TERMINOLOGY

- pavilioned: enclosed, encircled
- girded: dressed

• IMPORTANT DATE

Robert Grant (England/India, 1779-1838 AD)

WEEK 6 10m Folk Songs - Lesson 18

En roulant ma boule

Materials: Our Work or Music PDF, colored pencils, or markers

→ RECAP

Sing Amazing Grace from memory (or look at lyrics if needed). Think about the words and try to sing in a way that matches them!

→ INTRO

We're learning a new folk song today! In the 17th and 18th centuries, France claimed a significant portion of land in North America (see map link below). France's financial situation eventually collapsed, and they lost the Seven Years' War with England in 1763, but French voyageurs spent decades paddling through the Great Lakes and down the Mississippi and Missouri rivers (see Extra Helpings for more on the Voyageurs!) to transport furs. As they paddled, they sang to pass the time and keep their strokes even. Our folk song for the rest of this term was one of the songs the voyageurs sang.

∞ Map Link: New France in its Heyday

→ STUDY

The story of this song is odd and looks long, but you'll notice why it's a good paddling song when you listen to the tune and rhythm. But first, look at the lyrics in your Our Work/Music book. With your colored pencils or markers, mark, highlight, or underline the lines which are repeated (for instance, use the same color to highlight/mark the second and fourth line of each verse, which are ALWAYS the same).

→ LISTEN

If you can, follow along with the lyrics in your book as you listen. Pay attention especially to the refrain today and focus just on learning those words.

∞ Video Link: En roulant ma boule

∞ Image Link: En roulant sheet music (optional; helpful if you want to look at the tune)

WEEK 6 15m Composer Study - Lesson 18



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WEEK 7 15m Sol-fa: Level 5 - Lesson 19

Review: Step 23a

 Materials: Fifty Steps in Sight Singing

→ RECAP

Review concepts from the last lesson.

→ WARM UP

Prepare your voice for singing.

∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups

∞ Video Link: Warm-Ups

→ LISTEN & PRACTICE

Write, sing, or clap back melodies or rhythms as directed. With any extra time, try writing the exercise as a melody on the staff in your music journal.

∞ Audio Link: Step 23a

∞ Audio Link: Step 23a Answer Key (Note: Sing the low re at the end of the 4th line.) p.25

WEEK 7 10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 19

O Worship the King (cont.)

 Materials: Our Hymns, Our Heritage and/or Our Work or Music PDF

→ RECAP & MAPWORK

- What do you remember about our new song?
- Locate Mumbai, India (called Bombay during Sir Robert Grant's time) on your globe/atlas.

→ PRACTICE & SING

- Read the words aloud and work on learning them.
- Then work on the tune by alternating between listening to a verse and then humming along with the recording.
- ∞ Music Links: O Worship the King (YouTube V1, V2, or Spotify)

→ DISCUSS

If you could ask Sir Robert Grant a question about one of the lines or images in the hymn, what would it be?

WEEK 7 10m Folk Songs - Lesson 19

En roulant ma boule (cont.)

 Materials: Our Work or Music PDF, Bible

→ RECAP

What does "En roulant ma boule" mean? Warm up your voice by singing Amazing Grace.

→ LISTEN & SING

Listen once to the song and follow along with the lyrics in your book. Then listen again and try humming along with some of the verses.

∞ Video Link: En roulant ma boule

- Did you notice that when the first lines of the verse repeat, the singer sings them louder the second time? Why do you think that is?

WEEK 7 15m Composer Study - Lesson 19



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WEEK 8 15m Sol-fa: Level 5 - Lesson 20

Review Step 23b

Materials: Fifty Steps in Sight Singing

→ RECAP

Review concepts from the last lesson.

→ WARM UP

Prepare your voice for singing.

∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups

∞ Video Link: Warm-Ups

→ LISTEN & PRACTICE

Can you complete Step 23b easily? With any extra time, write and sing your own sol-fa exercise.

∞ Audio Link: Step 23b

∞ Audio Link: Step 23b Answer Key
p.25

WEEK 8 10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 20

O Worship the King (cont.)

Materials: Our Hymns, Our Heritage and/or Our Work or Music PDF, Bible

→ RECAP

Can you hum the melody of "O Worship the King"?

→ SING

Sing along with the hymn today.

∞ Video Link: O Worship the King (YouTube V1, V2, or Spotify)

→ READ & DISCUSS

- Sir Robert Grant was inspired by Psalm 104, or perhaps both Psalm 104 and a paraphrase of it from the 16th century by William Kethe (who wrote "All People That On Earth Do Dwell").

- Read Psalm 104:1-4 (or further if you like) and discuss the ways you see Grant working the ideas from the psalm into his poetry. Do you see echoes of any other Bible passages?

• EXTRA HELPINGS

The image of God riding upon the wind is common in both Scripture and in other hymns. If you learned "God Moves in a Mysterious Way" in Alveary hymn lessons last year, you might remember the line "he plants his footsteps in the sea and rides upon the storm." Look up Psalm 19, Isaiah 19, and Nahum 1 for other Bible passages with this imagery. Why do you think God is described this way?

WEEK 8 10m Folk Songs - Lesson 20

En roulant ma boule

Materials: Our Work or Music PDF

→ RECAP

Tell what you remember about the people who often sang "En roulant ma boule" in the 1600s and 1700s.

→ LISTEN & PRACTICE

As French voyageurs paddled, they often sang in a call-and-response format where the leader sang one line and the rest of the men responded. Try singing "En roulant ma boule" in this style by singing along on repeated sections. For instance, let the singer sing the first two lines of the refrain, then you join in when it's repeated. Similarly, listen to the first two lines of each verse and then try joining in when they are repeated. (The singer tries to naturally mimic this call-and-response style by singing louder on the repeated sections.)

∞ Video Link: En roulant ma boule



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WEEK 8 15m Composer Study - Lesson 20

WEEK 9 15m Sol-fa: Level 5 - Lesson 21

Review Step 23c

Materials: Fifty Steps in Sight Singing

→ RECAP

Review concepts from the last lesson.

→ WARM UP

Prepare your voice for singing.

∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups

∞ Video Link: Warm-Ups

→ LISTEN & PRACTICE

Can you complete Step 23c easily? With any extra time, write and sing your own sol-fa exercise.

∞ Audio Link: Step 23c

∞ Audio Link: Step 23c Answer Key

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WEEK 9 10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 21

O Worship the King (cont.)

Materials: Our Hymns, Our Heritage and/or Our Work or Music PDF

→ RECAP

What do you remember about the connections between Psalm 104 and "O Worship the King"?

→ SING

Sing along with the tune, and then try singing "O Worship the King" acapella (just your voice). Feel free to use lyrics or not, and try to express the meaning of the song as you sing.

∞ Video Link: O Worship the King Tune

→ ILLUSTRATE (GRADES 1-6; OPTION 1 GRADES 7+)

Draw or paint an illustration of an image in the song.

→ WRITE (GRADES 7+ OPTION 2)

Compose an additional verse to "O Worship the King" drawn from an idea or image in Psalm 104.

WEEK 9 10m Folk Songs - Lesson 21

En roulant ma boule (cont.)

Materials: Our Work or Music PDF

→ RECAP

Sing the refrain of "En roulant ma boule."

→ SING & PRACTICE

Pause the video after each line of the first verse (or first and second if you're up for a challenge) and sing it back by yourself, and finish by just listening to the rest of the song. Listen closely to the pronunciation!

∞ Video Link: En roulant ma boule



Term 2

WEEK 9 15m Composer Study - Lesson 21

WEEK 10 15m Sol-fa: Level 5 - Lesson 22

Singing at Sight

→ RECAP

Review concepts from the last lesson.

→ WARM UP

Prepare your voice for singing.

∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups

∞ Video Link: Warm-Ups

→ PRACTICE

Flip through a hymnal and pick a song in the key of C or F. See if you can figure out the rhythm and the sol-fa (it's a puzzle). (Hint: Remember hymns often end on do.)

Then use a piano or the online pitch pipe to hear your first note and sing!

∞ Audio Link: Online Pitch Pipe

WEEK 10 10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 22

O Worship the King (cont.)

Materials: Our Hymns, Our Heritage and/or Our Work or Music PDF

→ RECAP

Sing "O Worship the King" from memory (as able).

→ SING

Look over any tricky places and sing through the song. Then try again without any lyrics (and see if you can see it from memory). Experiment with singing it faster or slower, and think about how you might want to sing each verse and refrain differently to emphasize the meaning. (For instance, you might sing the part about "thunder" very loudly and then get quiet when you sing about "frail children of dust.")

∞ Video Link: O Worship the King Tune

→ LISTEN

This is another popular tune for this hymn and also includes a few of the less popular verses. What do you think?

∞ Video Link: Alternate Tune

WEEK 10 10m Folk Songs - Lesson 22

En roulant ma boule (cont.)

Materials: Our Work or Music PDF

→ RECAP

Can you sing the first verse of "En roulant ma boule" from memory?

→ SING

Sing along with the video for the sections you know. Pause and echo back the lines of the next verse or two you are working on.

∞ Video Link: En roulant ma boule

→ DISCUSS

If you wrote a paddle song, what would it be about? What tune would you use? If you want a challenge, try writing your own paddle song (tune and/or words) this week!

WEEK 10 15m Composer Study - Lesson 22



Term 2

WEEK 11 15m Sol-fa: Level 5 - Lesson 23

Melodic Dictation

→ RECAP

Review concepts from the last lesson.

→ WARM UP

Prepare your voice for singing.

∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups

∞ Video Link: Warm-Ups

→ LISTEN & PRACTICE

Write, sing, or clap back melodies or rhythms as directed.

∞ Audio Link: Mystery Tune Dictation

∞ Link: Mystery Tune Answer Key

WEEK 11 10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 23

Term Recap

📄 Materials: Our Hymns, Our Heritage and/or Our Work or Music PDF

→ RECAP

Hum a tune you know well to warm up your voice.

→ SING

Sing both the term's hymns as if you were a soloist (you may choose to sing with or without the accompaniment). If you wrote your own verse for "O Worship the King," sing it as well!

∞ Video Link: Angels We Have Heard Tune

∞ Video Link: O Worship the King Tune

WEEK 11 10m Folk Songs - Lesson 23

En roulant ma boule (cont.)

📄 Materials: Our Work or Music PDF

→ SING

Sing along with the video for the sections you know. Pause and echo back the lines of the next verse or two you are working on.

∞ Video Link: En roulant ma boule

WEEK 11 15m Composer Study - Lesson 23

WEEK 12 15m Sol-fa: Level 5 - Lesson 24

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to course.

Questions will come from:

Sol-fa Level 5 Coursework

WEEK 12 10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 24

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to course.

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Questions will come from: Hymns & Spirituals	
WEEK 12 10m Folk Songs - Lesson 24 Exam Week → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to the course. Questions will come from: The term's folk songs.	
WEEK 12 15m Composer Study - Lesson 24	



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WEEK 1 15m Sol-fa: Level 5 - Lesson 25

Review: Step 22

Materials: Fifty Steps in Sight Singing

→ RECAP

Review concepts from the last lesson.

→ WARM UP

Prepare your voice for singing.

∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups

∞ Video Link: Warm-Ups

→ LISTEN & PRACTICE

Revisit Step 22. Can you sing the exercises easily?

∞ Audio Link: Step 22a Answer Key

∞ Audio Link: Step 22b Answer Key

∞ Audio Link: Step 22c Answer Key

p.22-23

WEEK 1 10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 25

Hallelujah! What a Savior

Materials: Our Hymns, Our Heritage and/or Our Work or Music PDF

→ INTRO

Have you ever heard the hymn, "It is Well with my Soul"? Philip Bliss was the author of that hymn and our next hymn this year, a popular Easter hymn.

→ LISTEN & PRACTICE

Read the hymn aloud and then listen to your preferred recording.

∞ Music Links: Hallelujah! What a Savior (YouTube or Spotify)

→ READ & DISCUSS

Our Hymn, Our Heritage "Text & Tune" p.70

∞ (Optional) Article Link: Additional History

• IMPORTANT DATES

Phillip Bliss (US, 1838-1876 AD)

"Hallelujah! What a Savior" published (1875 AD)

WEEK 1 10m Folk Songs - Lesson 25

Shenandoah

Materials: Our Work or Music PDF

PREP: Print sheet music if desired.

∞ Image Link: Shenandoah Sheet Music

→ INTRO

What do you remember about "En roulant ma boule" from last term? We're learning two more songs that might have been sung on the water this term! The first is called "Shenandoah."

→ READ & SING

Staying true to folk tradition, the lyrics for Shenandoah have multiple historical roots and are a bit cryptic. Read the words in your Our Work/Music book, then listen to the song and read the video caption.

∞ Video Link: Shenandoah

WEEK 1 15m Composer Study - Lesson 25



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WEEK 2 15m Sol-fa: Level 5 - Lesson 26

Review: Step 24

 Materials: Fifty Steps in Sight Singing

→ RECAP

Review concepts from the last lesson.

→ WARM UP

Prepare your voice for singing.

∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups

∞ Video Link: Warm-Ups

→ LISTEN & PRACTICE

Revisit Step 24. Can you sing the exercises easily?

∞ Audio Link: Step 24c Answer Key

∞ Audio Link: Step 24d Answer Key

∞ Audio Link: Step 24e Answer Key

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WEEK 2 10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 26

Hallelujah! What a Savior (cont.)

 Materials: Our Hymns, Our Heritage and/or Our Work or Music PDF, Globe/Atlas

→ RECAP

What do you remember about the history of our current hymn and its author?

→ SING

Hum a favorite tune to warm up your voice. Then alternate between listening to a verse and "hooing" for a verse (sing the tune on "hoo") to learn the tune.

∞ Music Links: Hallelujah! What a Savior (YouTube or Spotify)

→ PRACTICE

Continue learning the words. Read the whole song aloud. Write down the first line of each verse to help you remember the order, sketch a small illustration for each verse to help you visualize it, and do anything else you like to help yourself learn the words!

→ DISCUSS

Do you think there is a progression to the ideas in the hymn's verses? Describe how you think each verse builds (or doesn't build) on the previous ones. How would the hymn feel different if you changed the order?

WEEK 2 10m Folk Songs - Lesson 26

Shenandoah (cont.)

 Materials: Our Work or Music PDF, US atlas

→ MAPWORK & RECAP

Locate the Missouri River in your atlas or online. What is Shenandoah about?

→ SING & PRACTICE

Read the lyrics aloud, then listen to the song, listening to a verse and then humming the next.

∞ Video Link: Shenandoah



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- How does this song feel different than "En roulant ma boule"? What type of boat or work do you think this song suits best?

WEEK 2 15m Composer Study - Lesson 26

WEEK 3 15m Sol-fa: Level 5 - Lesson 27

Step 28a

 Materials: Fifty Steps in Sight Singing

→ RECAP

Review concepts from the last lesson.

→ WARM UP

Prepare your voice for singing.

∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups

∞ Video Link: Warm-Ups

→ LISTEN & PRACTICE

Write, sing, or clap back melodies or rhythms as directed.

∞ Audio Link: Step 28a

∞ Audio Link: Step 28a Answer Key

p.29

WEEK 3 10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 27

Hallelujah! What a Savior (cont.)

 Materials: Our Hymns, Our Heritage and/or Our Work or Music PDF

→ RECAP

Hum "Hallelujah! What a Savior."

→ SING

We'll put the words and tune together today! Listen to the song and pause it after each line to echo it back. Try to think about the meaning of the words as you sing.

∞ Video Links: Hallelujah! What a Savior (YouTube or Spotify)

→ DISCUSS

Where do you see Charles Wesley meditating on Scripture in this hymn? For instance, it seems like Isaiah 35:5-8 and a number of other scriptures must have been in the back of his head when he wrote verse 4.

∞ Article Link: Verse 4 References

WEEK 3 10m Folk Songs - Lesson 27

Shenandoah (cont.)

 Materials: Our Work or Music PDF

→ RECAP

Can you sing (or hum) the tune of the Shenandoah?

→ SING

Sing along with the video today. It may be helpful to pause after each line to sing the song back to give equal attention to all the words.

∞ Video Link: Shenandoah

→ READ



Term 3

Learn more about Chief John Skenandoah. (Teachers may share selections for younger students.)
 ∞ Article Link: 1912 Tribute to Shenandoah

WEEK 3 15m Composer Study - Lesson 27

WEEK 4 15m Sol-fa: Level 5 - Lesson 28 Step 28b

Materials: Fifty Steps in Sight Singing

→ RECAP

Review concepts from the last lesson.

→ WARM UP

Prepare your voice for singing.

∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups

∞ Video Link: Warm-Ups

→ LISTEN & PRACTICE

Write, sing, or clap back melodies or rhythms as directed.

∞ Audio Link: Step 28b

∞ Audio Link: Step 28b Answer Key

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WEEK 4 10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 28

Hallelujah! What a Savior (cont.)

Materials: Our Hymns, Our Heritage and/or Our Work or Music PDF, Bible

→ RECAP

What is your favorite verse of "Hallelujah! What a Savior"?

→ SING

Hum a hymn from last term to warm up your voice. Then sing with the accompaniment. Note any spots where you need to work more.

∞ Music Links: Hallelujah! What a Savior Tune

→ DISCUSS & READ

What Bible verses or stories do you hear echoed in the song? Can you find them in the Bible?

★ TEACHER NOTE

Here are a few chapters with relevant verses to read and discuss if needed.

Isaiah 53

Philippians 12

John 19

1 Peter 1

WEEK 4 10m Folk Songs - Lesson 28

Shenandoah (cont.)

Materials: Our Work or Music PDF

→ RECAP

Who was Chief John Shenandoah?

→ SING

Can you sing the first verse without looking at the lyrics? Sing along with the video today for the rest of the song, pausing to repeat any lines you are still working on.

∞ Video Link: Shenandoah

→ LISTEN

With extra time, listen to this orchestral rendition of the song.

∞ Video Link: Shenandoah (orchestra)

• IMPORTANT DATE

Chief John Skenandoah
 (New York, 1706-1816 AD)



Term 3

WEEK 4 15m Composer Study - Lesson 28

WEEK 5 15m Sol-fa: Level 5 - Lesson 29

Compose

→ RECAP

Review concepts from the last lesson.

→ WARM UP

Prepare your voice for singing.

∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups

∞ Video Link: Warm-Ups

→ PRACTICE

Compose your own melody in the key of F and then sing it. Label all the notes with the sol-fa syllables and their names, and make sure to mark the key signature and the measure of the piece (2/4, 3/4, or 4/4 time).

WEEK 5 10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 29

Hallelujah! What a Savior (cont.)

Materials: Our Hymns, Our Heritage and/or Our Work or Music PDF

→ RECAP

Recite "Hallelujah! What a Savior" (as able). Remember to pay attention to the punctuation and not just the line breaks when you're saying rather than singing the hymn.

→ SING

Hum a favorite tune to warm up your voice. Sing with the accompaniment and then try to sing the hymn without any recording. Can you sing it all from memory?

∞ Video Link: Hallelujah! What a Savior Tune

→ VIEW (GRADES 5+)

Explore the book where our hymn was first published in 1875!

∞ Book Link: Gospel Hymns & Sacred Songs

WEEK 5 10m Folk Songs - Lesson 29

Shenandoah (cont.)

Materials: Our Work or Music PDF

→ SING

Sing Shenandoah a cappella, and try to see how far you can make it without looking at the lyrics. Check your work with the full song and practice any spots you don't know as well. Think about how your tone creates the meaning and emotion in the song, and try singing the song a few different ways (faster, slower, louder, softer, etc).

∞ Video Link: Shenandoah

→ ILLUSTRATE

With extra time or on your own time, if interested, sketch or paint an illustration to go with the song.

• AFTERNOON LISTENING

Listen to a different version of Shenandoah!

∞ Video Link: Sissel's Shenandoah

WEEK 5 15m Composer Study - Lesson 29



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WEEK 6 15m Sol-fa: Level 5 - Lesson 30

Step 28c

Materials: Fifty Steps in Sight Singing

→ RECAP

Review concepts from the last lesson.

→ WARM UP

Prepare your voice for singing.

∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups

∞ Video Link: Warm-Ups

→ LISTEN & PRACTICE

Write, sing, or clap back melodies or rhythms as directed.

∞ Audio Link: Step 28c

∞ Audio Link: Step 28c Answer Key

p.29-30

WEEK 6 10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 30

When Morning Gilds the Skies

Materials: Our Hymns, Our Heritage and/or Our Work or Music PDF

→ RECAP

Sing "Hallelujah! What a Savior."

→ INTRO

- What was happening in the world during the 1800s? Tell about a few things you have learned in other subjects.

- Our last hymn for the year is from the mid-1800s. Don't forget that people have always sung these hymns in the midst of world events and the joys and struggles of everyday life – which you're learning about in other subjects!

→ SING & PRACTICE

Read the lyrics aloud, discuss unfamiliar words, and then listen to the full song (Note that the first version skips verse 3 in your lyrics, and the second version includes a 5th verse. So decide whether you'd like to learn three or five verses and adjust your lyrics accordingly.)

∞ Music Links: When Morning Gilds the Skies (YouTube V1, V2, or Spotify)

→ READ & DISCUSS

Learn the history of the song from your hymnal.

"Text & Tune" p.203

• IMPORTANT DATE

"When Morning Gilds the Skies" published (German: 1828 AD, English 1854 AD)

• TERMINOLOGY

-gild: to cover with a thin layer of gold
-canticle: song

Fun fact: The last quarter or so of the 19th century is sometimes called the "Gilded Age" in US history.

WEEK 6 10m Folk Songs - Lesson 30

Michael, Row the Boat Ashore

Materials: Like a Bird, Our Work or Music PDF, atlas

PREP: If this book is new to you, read p.5 with your students.

→ RECAP

Sing Shenandoah to warm up your voice and refresh your memory.

→ INTRO

Unlike our previous folk songs from the north and Midwest, "Michael Row the Boat



Term 3

Ashore" comes from the east. Read a little about the song from Like a Bird, p.13.

→ LISTEN

Read the lyrics in your Our Work or Music book and then listen to the full song.

∞ Video Link: Michael, Row the Boat Ashore

→ MAPWORK

Look up the Georgia Sea Islands in your atlas or online.

WEEK 6 15m Composer Study - Lesson 30

WEEK 7 15m Sol-fa: Level 5 - Lesson 31

Step 29a

Materials: Fifty Steps in Sight Singing

→ RECAP

Review concepts from the last lesson.

→ WARM UP

Prepare your voice for singing.

∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups

∞ Video Link: Warm-Ups

→ LISTEN & PRACTICE

Write, sing, or clap back melodies or rhythms as directed.

∞ Audio Link: Step 29a

p.30

WEEK 7 10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 31

When Morning Gilds the Skies (cont.)

Materials: Our Work or Music PDF and US Atlas

→ RECAP & INTRO

What does "gild" mean? What is the author describing when he says "when morning gilds the skies"?

→ SING

Hum a favorite tune to warm up your voice. Then alternate between listening to a verse and "hoing" a verse to practice the tune.

∞ Music Links: When Morning Gilds the Skies (YouTube V1, V2, or Spotify)

→ READ & DISCUSS

Read the lyrics aloud and pay close attention to the first line of each verse, as that is the orienting piece of each verse, since they all end with the same refrain.

→ EXPLORE

The first English translations of this hymn are quite long. Read through one or both. Why do you think the four verses we're learning are the most popular? Are there any other verses you particularly like? (Feel free to copy them in your notebook and learn them as well!)

∞ Book Link: Original Lyrics by Caswall

∞ Book Link: Yattendon Hymnal lyrics (Bridges lyrics)



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WEEK 7 10m Folk Songs - Lesson 31

Michael, Row the Boat Ashore

Materials: Our Work or Music PDF

→ RECAP

Can you hum a part of our new song? What is its name?

→ SING

Like all of our rowing songs, "Michael, Row the Boat Ashore" can also be sung in a call-and-response format. This week, sing along with the response sections the "Hallelujah" after each line.

∞ Video Link: Michael, Row the Boat Ashore

→ LISTEN

Hear a version of our song sung in a call-and-response format. Notice the alternate lyrics as well.

∞ Video Link: Michael, Row the Boat (Call & Response)

WEEK 7 15m Composer Study - Lesson 31

WEEK 8 15m Sol-fa: Level 5 - Lesson 32

Step 29b

Materials: Fifty Steps in Sight Singing

→ RECAP

Review concepts from the last lesson.

→ WARM UP

Prepare your voice for singing.

∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups

∞ Video Link: Warm-Ups

→ LISTEN & PRACTICE

Write, sing, or clap back melodies or rhythms as directed.

∞ Audio Link: Step 29b

p.30

WEEK 8 10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 32

When Morning Gilds the Skies (cont.)

Materials: Our Work or Music PDF, Bible

→ RECAP

Can you hum the tune of "When Morning Gilds the Skies"?

→ SING

If you are feeling confident with the melody, sing the full song along with the recording. For any sections that you find difficult, pause your preferred recording after a line and echo it back.

∞ Music Links: When Morning Gilds the Skies (YouTube V1, V2, or Spotify)

→ DISCUSS

- Read 1 Corinthians 10:31. Perhaps the author thought of this verse when he wrote our hymn.

- If you wrote a new verse or two, what places or times would you include? Think of



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times when it's easy or hard to do everything to the glory of God. In a way, this hymn is a prayer you can pray as you sing - that in every situation you sing about, you would turn to Jesus and he would be praised.

WEEK 8 10m Folk Songs - Lesson 32

Michael, Row the Boat Ashore

Materials: Our Work or Music PDF

→ RECAP

Can you hum the whole tune of "Michael, Row the Boat Ashore?"

→ SING

Take the role of the "leader" today and sing the first part of each line (not the "Hallelujah").

∞ Video Link: Michael, Row the Boat Ashore

→ STUDY

No one knows exactly when this song first started, but possibly as early as the 1700s, rowers would make up their own verses.

∞ Song Link: Additional Lyrics

- How do these verses add to your understanding of the song?
- Consider learning a few more verses OR making up a few of your own.

★ TEACHER NOTE

In a group context, teachers can divide the class and have one half sing each line while the others respond with the "Hallelujah."

WEEK 8 15m Composer Study - Lesson 32

WEEK 9 15m Sol-fa: Level 5 - Lesson 33

Step 30a

Materials: Fifty Steps in Sight Singing

→ RECAP

Review concepts from the last lesson.

→ WARM UP

Prepare your voice for singing.

∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups

∞ Video Link: Warm-Ups

→ LISTEN & PRACTICE

Work on the exercise in 2/4 on p.30. Use what you know about accidentals to write the sol-fa syllables and sing the tune. Then check your work.

∞ Audio Link: Step 30a Answer Key

p.30

WEEK 9 10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 33

When Morning Gilds the Skies (cont.)

Materials: Our Work or Music PDF

→ RECAP

Can you sing the first verse lines of each verse of "When Morning Gilds the Skies"?

→ SING

Sing with the accompaniment (use the words in your PDF or hymnal as needed) and check your work. Go back and listen to the full song if needed.

∞ Video Link: When Morning Gilds the Skies Tune



Term 3

→ DISCUSS

Do you think there is a pattern to the verses? How would the song change if you rearranged them?

WEEK 9

10m Folk Songs - Lesson 33

Michael, Row the Boat Ashore (cont.)

 Materials: Our Work or Music PDF

→ RECAP

Can you tell the first lines of each of the verses you've learned for "Michael, Row the Boat Ashore"?

→ SING

Listen to the video and then try singing the song completely by yourself.

∞ Video Link: Michael, Row the Boat Ashore

→ DISCUSS

How is "Michael, Row the Boat Ashore" similar or different from "Shenandoah" or "En roulant ma boule"? Which is your favorite water song?

WEEK 9

15m Composer Study - Lesson 33

WEEK 10

15m Sol-fa: Level 5 - Lesson 34

Step 30b

 Materials: Fifty Steps in Sight Singing

→ RECAP

Review concepts from the last lesson.

→ WARM UP

Prepare your voice for singing.

∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups

∞ Video Link: Warm-Ups

→ LISTEN & PRACTICE

Work on the exercise in 3/4 on p.30. Use what you know about accidentals to write the sol-fa syllables and sing the tune. Then check your work.

∞ Audio Link: Step 30b Answer Key
p.30

WEEK 10

10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 34

When Morning Gilds the Skies (cont.)

 Materials: Our Work or Music PDF, painting or sketching supplies

→ RECAP

Orally or in writing, describe "When Morning Gilds the Skies" as if talking to a friend who hasn't heard of it.

→ SING

Hum a favorite tune to warm up your voice. Sing with the accompaniment recording and then try to sing the hymn without any recording. Can you sing it all from memory?

∞ Video Link: When Morning Gilds the Skies Tune



Term 3

→ ILLUSTRATE

With remaining time or on your own time, paint an illustration to go along with the hymn.

WEEK 10 10m Folk Songs - Lesson 34

Michael, Row the Boat Ashore (cont.)

 Materials: Our Work or Music PDF

→ RECAP

Do you remember the words to "Shenandoah"?

→ SING

Sing "Michael, Row the Boat Ashore" from memory, then listen to the video to check your work. Remember, you can add extra verses you've learned or composed if you like!

∞ Video Link: Michael, Row the Boat Ashore

→ ILLUSTRATE

With extra time, sketch or paint an illustration to go with this song.

WEEK 10 15m Composer Study - Lesson 34

WEEK 11 15m Sol-fa: Level 5 - Lesson 35

Step 30c

 Materials: Fifty Steps in Sight Singing

→ RECAP

Review concepts from the last lesson.

→ WARM UP

Prepare your voice for singing.

∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups

∞ Video Link: Warm-Ups

→ LISTEN & PRACTICE

Work on the exercise in 2/4 on p.31. Use what you know about accidentals to write the sol-fa syllables and sing the tune. Then check your work.

∞ Audio Link: Step 30c Answer Key
p.31

WEEK 11 10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 35

Term Recap

 Materials: Our Hymns, Our Heritage and/or Our Work or Music PDF

→ RECAP

Hum a hymn from last term (or even last year!) to warm up your voice.

→ SING

Sing both of the term's hymns as if you were a soloist (you may choose to sing with or without the piano accompaniment).

∞ Video Link: Hallelujah! What a Savior Tune

∞ Video Link: When Morning Gilds the Skies Tune



Term 3

WEEK 11 10m Folk Songs - Lesson 35

Term Recap

Materials: Our Work or Music PDF

→ SING

Make sure to stand when you sing and do a few warm-ups to get your voice ready. Sing both folk songs from the term (maybe even try singing one from earlier in the year too!).

→ DISCUSS

Look back at your Our Work/Music book and discuss your favorite folk songs from the year.

WEEK 11 15m Composer Study - Lesson 35

WEEK 12 15m Sol-fa: Level 5 - Lesson 36

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to course.

Questions will come from:

Sol-fa Level 5 Coursework

WEEK 12 10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 36

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to course.

Questions will come from:

Hymns & Spirituals

WEEK 12 10m Folk Songs - Lesson 36

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to the course.

Questions will come from:

Folk Songs

WEEK 12 15m Composer Study - Lesson 36

Music: Level 5

Examination

Term 1

Hymns & Spirituals

- Sing "Children of the Heavenly Father" and tell what you know about the life and times of Carolina Berg.

Folk Songs

- Sing "Yankee Doodle" (add in your own verses if you came up with some!) OR "Sakura, Sakura" and tell a little about the song.

Sol-fa: Level 5

- Sing and record the last exercise completed.
- Write the scale of F with the correct key signature on the staff.

Term 2

Hymns & Spirituals

- Sing "Angels We Have Heard on High" OR Draw or paint a new illustration to go with one of your hymns from this term. Underneath your work, write the line or verse from the hymn that your illustration reflects and write or tell why you chose the passage to illustrate.

Folk Songs

- Sing "Amazing Grace" and the refrain (or more if you want) of "En roulant ma boule."

Sol-fa: Level 5

- Sing and record the last exercise completed.
- Compose a short melody in the key of G in 2/4 time and then sing it.

Term 3

Hymns & Spirituals

- Sing "When Morning Gilds the Skies" and tell which verse is your favorite (or least favorite) and why.

Folk Songs

- Sing "Shenandoah" and tell what you remember about Chief John Skenandoah.

Sol-fa: Level 5

- Sing and record the last exercise completed.
- What should you do if you see a natural sign while singing?